

# IELTS Writing: GT Letter Pack

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## Book 20 · General Training Task 1 letters that hit the purpose

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## Who this is for

Academic students skip this.

**General Training** candidates need letters: formal / semi-formal / informal.

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## Core rules

- Cover **all bullet points** in the prompt
- Match tone to the reader
- Clear purpose in the opening
- Usually 150+ words

## Tone chooser

| Reader                        | Tone        | Opening feel                               |
|-------------------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Manager / unknown official    | Formal      | <i>Dear Sir or Madam, / Dear Mr Smith,</i> |
| Landlord / colleague you know | Semi-formal | <i>Dear Mr/Ms...,</i> polite but direct    |
| Friend                        | Informal    | <i>Dear Alex, / Hi Sam,</i>                |

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## Letter skeleton

1. Greeting
2. Purpose sentence
3. Bullet 1 developed
4. Bullet 2 developed
5. Bullet 3 developed
6. Polite closing + sign-off

## Sign-offs

Formal: *Yours faithfully* (name unknown) / *Yours sincerely* (name known)

Informal: *Best wishes* / *See you soon*

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## Useful phrases

**Formal request:** I am writing to request... / I would be grateful if you could...

**Complaint:** I am writing to express concern about...

**Informal news:** Just wanted to tell you about...

**Suggest:** One possible option would be...

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## Mini model (formal complaint — original)

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to complain about the repeated delays on the morning bus route 21 during the past two weeks.

The bus has arrived 15–20 minutes late on several weekdays, which has made me late for work. In addition, the electronic display at the stop often shows incorrect times, so passengers cannot plan reliably.

I would be grateful if you could investigate the scheduling problem and improve the accuracy of the stop information. I look forward to your response.

Yours faithfully,  
A. Rahman

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## Practice prompts

1. Write to a landlord about a broken heater (explain problem / say how it affects you / request action).
2. Write to a friend about inviting them to stay (when / what you can do / what to bring).
3. Write to a manager asking for time off (reason / dates / how work will be covered).

Check letters at <https://stratumielts.com>.

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*End of Book 20 · stratumielts.com*